

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN HYDERABAD REGION

PRE- BOARD EXAMINATION - I 2024-25

CLASS - X

SUBJECT- ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE (101)

TIME: 3 HRS

SET 2

MM: 80

General Instruction:

- 15-minute prior reading time allotted for Q-paper reading.
- Question Paper contains FOUR sections-
- **READING SKILLS, WRITING SKILLS, GRAMMAR and LITERATURE TEXTBOOK.**
- Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (22 marks)

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow: 12m

1. According to the Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) 2013, the proportion of all children nationally in Class V who can read a Class II level text remains virtually the same since 2012: 47 per cent. Among Class V children in government schools, this percentage has decreased to 41.1 percent.

2. The household-based annual education survey covers six lakh children in the age group 3- 16 across 550 districts, about 16,000 villages, and 3.3 lakh households. Despite the dismal figures it throws up, there is some hope still. It comes not so much from the formal learning centres as from the work of volunteers and organisations around the country that are doing stellar work to promote reading among rural children. Learning to read is not an instinctive act like learning to talk, run, or play. But there is no doubt that the ability to read is one of the most important skills children need for their development. Why are children, especially in rural schools, not reading?

3. "Are you asking about reading skills, or children's inclination to read?" asks Neha Pradhan Arora, Head of Programmes at Swechha, which runs Pagdandi, a volunteer-driven alternative educational space for children of resettlement and slum colonies in Delhi. Since 2009, it has reached hundreds of children in Jagdamba Camp. "The ability to read depends upon learning and teaching, but reading for pleasure depends on access to books. That's the reason we started Kitabghar. Reading is first a skill, then becomes a joy, and only after that can it empower the child."

4. Pagdandi runs monthly reading days, and conducts periodical reading-related events. Like Pagdandi, there are hundreds of organisations and individuals who have made it their mission to promote reading for pleasure among children. "Children anywhere will read if they are introduced to the act of reading in the right

environment," says Sathyanarayanan Mundayoor, fondly known as Uncle Moosa. This extraordinary crusader has been instrumental in setting up 13 libraries, called Bamboosa Libraries, in the villages of Arunachal Pradesh through the Lohit Youth Libraries programme.

5. "In Arunachal Pradesh, even the government finds it difficult because of connectivity and terrain. The only hope for promoting reading is the school system. But when these schools lack even basic facilities, having a library is not easy. After coming under Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, officials are unable to pay attention to teacher training and other aspects of school governance. Added to this is the fact that reading is taught only as a means to teach other subjects," says Mundayoor, who has been working in Arunachal Pradesh for over three decades. "Volunteers, are eager to work with reading-deprived children. Books are accessible and kept in open cupboards. Unlike the top-down approach of school librarians, where they decide what and when a child should read, here the volunteers encourage children to read whatever they choose. Volunteers return to their own villages and start similar reading rooms."

6. That children love stories is universal. "Children need to be surrounded by books. When reading for pleasure is not part of the culture, there is no push to read. Our children need books that are colourful, exciting and in languages they can read. They need books that have humour. The only way children will learn to read is if they have books to touch and see and read," says Suzanne Singh, chairperson, Pratham Books

7. Says Barbara Schmid, a social welfare manager who moved from Germany to Kalkeri six years ago, "Young children are very curious. Even if they are unable to read, they are eager to read, and this makes them quick learners. The older children who have come late to our school find it difficult. The key to inculcate the habit of reading for pleasure is to provide the atmosphere as early in life as possible.

8. The Accelerated Reading Programme developed by Akshara Foundation, a Karnataka based non-profit, reverses this process. Their technique starts with 'reading' from the first day. Children imagine and wonder, trying to make sense of what they see. They stumble, 'read', guess at words, try and understand its meaning, and eventually learn to read.

9. To mark International Literacy Day in September 2013, Pratham Books invited volunteers to spread the joy of reading. We expected 100 volunteers; we got more than 600, who conducted over 1000 book-reading and storytelling sessions in 25 languages across India. That is a small sprinkling of magic dust, but given the serious issue of children not being able to read in India, we need many more warriors like Uncle Moosa.

1. What does ability to read depend upon? (1m)
 - a. access to books.
 - b. learning and teaching
 - c library facilities d
 - social environment.
2. The Accelerated Reading Programme developed by Akshara Foundation, a Karnataka based non-profit, reverses this process. List two ways, how the process is reversed. Answer in 30- 40 words. (2m)
3. Why has Uncle Moosa been called a crusader? (1m)
4. In Arunachal Pradesh, even the government finds it difficult because of connectivity and terrain. This means that reading could not be promoted in Arunachal Pradesh because (1m)
 - a. Libraries cannot be set up because of lack of buildings
 - b. People cannot travel in Arunachal Pradesh.
 - c. The hilly land makes it difficult for constructing buildings for libraries and also for commuting
 - d. There is poor communication and lack of transportation facilities
5. Briefly explain (in 30-40 words) 'According to the Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) 2013 the proportion of all children nationally in Class V who can read a Class II level text remains virtually the same since 2012: 47 percent.' (2m)
6. Which of the following is the right sequence for Reading? (1m)
 - a. Enjoyment- empowerment- ability
 - b. Ability- empowerment- enjoyment
 - c. interest- empowerment- enjoyment
 - d. Ability- enjoyment- empowerment
7. What is the top-down approach of a librarian? (1m)
8. Which paragraph discusses 'word attack' skills? (1m)
9. Complete the sentence appropriately. Despite the dismal figures it throws up, there is some hope still as _____(para 2) (1m)
10. State whether the given assertion is TRUE or FALSE. (1m)
Reading for pleasure is not part of Indian culture.

Q2. Read the passage given below and answer the following questions. 10M

1. I got posted in Srinagar in the 1980s. Its rugged mountains, gushing rivers and vast meadows reminded me of the landscapes of my native place - the Jibhi Valley in Himachal Pradesh. Unlike Srinagar that saw numerous tourists, Jibhi Valley remained clouded in anonymity. That's when the seed for starting tourism in Jibhi

was planted. I decided to leave my service in the Indian Army and follow the urge to return home.

2. We had two houses - a family house and a traditional house, which we often rented out. I pleaded with my father to ask the tenant to vacate the house so that I could convert it into a guesthouse. When my family finally relented, I renovated the house keeping its originality intact, just adding windows for sunlight.

3. I still remember the summer of 1992 when I put a signboard outside my first guesthouse in Jibhi Valley! The village residents, however, were sceptical about my success. My business kept growing but it took years for tourism to take off in Jibhi Valley. Things changed significantly after 2008 when the government launched a home stay scheme. People built home stays and with rapid tourism growth, the region changed rapidly. Villages turned into towns with many concrete buildings. Local businesses and tourists continued putting a burden on nature.

4. Then, with the 2020-21 pandemic and lockdown, tourism came to a complete stand still in Jibhi Valley. Local people, who were employed at over a hundred home stays and guesthouses, returned to their villages. Some went back to farming; some took up pottery and some got involved in government work schemes. Now, all ardently hope that normalcy and tourism will return to the valley soon. In a way, the pandemic has given us an opportunity to introspect, go back to our roots and look for sustainable solutions.

5. For me, tourism has been my greatest teacher. It brought people from many countries and all states of India to my guest house. It gave me exposure to different cultures and countless opportunities to learn new things. Most people who stayed at my guest house became my repeat clients and good friends. When I look back, I feel proud, yet humbled at the thought that I was not only able to fulfil my dream despite all the challenges, but also play a role in establishing tourism in the beautiful valley that I call home.

(1) How does the setting contribute to the overall mood and atmosphere of the story in the passage? (1m)

(a) The setting creates a sense of isolation and desolation, enhancing a melancholic mood.

(b) The setting adds to the vibrancy and liveliness, contributing to an upbeat and cheerful atmosphere.

(c) The setting has no impact on the mood and atmosphere of the story.

(d) The setting evokes a sense of nostalgia, connecting the narrator's experiences with their native place.

(2) State how the emotions felt by the author when renovating the traditional house for the guest house are analogous to the anticipation and excitement one might experience when transforming a cherished space into a fulfilling and purposeful endeavour. (2m)

(3) What is the main flaw in the actions of local businessmen in relation to nature (1m)

(a) Excessive deforestation for commercial purposes.

(b) Unregulated construction and rapid development.

(c) Over reliance on government works chimes.

(d) Failure to adapt to sustainable agricultural practice

(4) Substitute the underlined word in the following sentence with a word/ phrase from paragraph 5 that means the same. (1m)

'After joining the international conference, the young scientist had experience to cutting-edge research'.

(5) What is the most significant lesson that the author learned during the pandemic? (1m)

(a) The importance of rapid tourism growth.

(b) The necessity of diversifying business options.

(c) The resilience of the local community.

(d) The effectiveness of government work schemes.

(6) Complete the sentence appropriately. (2m)

From the statement, 'The village residents, however, were sceptical about my success 'one can infer that

(7) Complete the sentence appropriately. (1m)

If the title, 'A Tale of Missed Opportunities 'would be given to the passage, it would be inappropriate, as compared to the title 'establishing Tourism in Jibhi Valley 'because

(8) State whether the given assertion is TRUE or FALSE. (1m)

The author plays a pivotal role in establishing tourism in the region despite initial scepticisms and subsequent challenges.

SECTION B- WRITING (22M)

Q3 You are Satvika/Satvik, class leader of Class X, section B. The projector in your classroom is malfunctioning. Report this to the Principal in an email. (3m)

Q4 Write a factual description of your favourite 'cartoon' character, in about 100 words, based on the hints given below. (4m)

Name of the character; description; qualities; what do you like most about it?

Q5 (A) Write a letter to the Mayor of your city, addressing the issue of carelessness in transportation habits and advocating for initiatives to promote 'car-lessness' in the community. Deliberate on the environmental, health, and social benefits of reducing reliance on cars and propose specific measures to encourage alternative modes of transportation. Also, emphasize the importance of community engagement and collaboration in achieving a more sustainable and livable city. Use ideas from Unit 3: Science, along with your own to write this letter in not more than 120 words. (7m)

OR

(B) Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper expressing your views on 'The Importance of Saving Water' as you have seen people wasting water carelessly on one hand and on the other hand people fight for a single drop of water and farmers die because of drought. Write the letter using your own ideas and the ideas given in the question.

6 (A) Sports and games play an integral part in keeping a person fit and healthy. Along with the sports and games, yoga also contributes to reducing stress in life and improving the quality of life. As Gaurav Dutta of class X, write an article in about 150 words titled 'The way to a healthy life.' Discuss the various contributors for stress in modern day life and give suggestions to overcome the negativity in life and lead a healthy and happy life. Use the given cues, along with your own ideas and those you may have gathered from Unit 1: Health and Medicine, to create this article. 8M

- Stiff competition, need to excel, need to prove oneself, maintain an image as factors of stress
- Sedentary lifestyle, lack of exercise, unhealthy food habits as contributors to many diseases
- Exercise routine, yoga, laughter yoga, meditation, healthy eating habits as counters to stress and diseases

OR

(B) Write an article about the latest advancements in renewable energy technologies. Highlight solar, wind, and hydroelectric power, discuss innovations in energy storage and distribution, and the potential impact on global carbon emissions.

- Solar, wind, and hydroelectric power advances have improved renewable energy efficiency and accessibility.
- Innovations in photovoltaic cells, wind turbines, and hydroelectric systems are expanding clean energy globally.
- Energy storage technologies such as batteries and pumped-storage hydroelectricity enhance renewable energy reliability.
- These developments are critical for reducing global carbon emissions by replacing fossil fuel-based electricity.

SECTION C (GRAMMAR) (10Marks)

7. (A) Fill the blanks (i) - (iii) with the appropriate option from those given in brackets. (3m)

When I (i) (come/return/turned) back, I saw my friends laughing. I wondered what (ii) (could/can/is) be the reason. Then I (iii) (stare/noticed/realised) that my shirt had a black stain on the sleeve.

7 (B) The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line. Write the incorrect word and the correct word in the space provided. (4m)

	ERROR	CORRECTION
Culture play an important role in the development of a nation.		
It represents a set in shared attitudes, values, goals and practices.		
Cultural and creativity manifest themselves in		
almost some economical, social and other activities.		

7 (c) i) Rearrange the following jumbled words to for a meaningful sentence. (1m)

wins the 23rd national / 35-year-old / para swimming championship / a / visually impaired army man

(ii) Report the dialogues to complete the paragraph given below.

2M

Customer: Why is the meal so sour?

Waiter: Nobody has complained for five days sir, about the meal.

Customer: What! Where is the Manager?

Waiter: He has gone to some other hotel to take dinner, sir.

One day a customer was taking dinner in a hotel. He asked the waiter why (a) The waiter told him (b) At this, the customer was shocked and wanted to know where the Manager was. The waiter replied that he had gone to some other hotel to take dinner.

SECTION D (LITERATURE TEXT BOOK) [26 Marks]

8. Read the extracts given below and answer the questions briefly for ANY TWO extracts of the three.
(4 + 4 = 8m)

A) Look at the picture carefully and answer the questions given below:



(i) What can you see in the picture? Does the man look happy? Give reasons for your answer.

(ii) Why does he have the bird hanging around his neck?

(iii) The phrase 'having an albatross around your neck' means.....

(a) something that you can always be proud of

(b) something that you have to do because you have no choice

(c) something that is with you all the time as a reminder that you have done something wrong ?

(iv)

What is an Albatross?

B) But here's a parchment with the seal of Caesar;

I found it in his closet, it's his Will:

Let but the commons hear this testament—

Which, pardon me, I do not mean to read—

And they would go and kiss dead Caesar's wounds

(i) Who speaks these words? Where is the speaker at this moment?

- (ii) What are the contents of 'Caesar's Will' that he is referring to?
- (iii) Why does the speaker read 'Caesar's Will' to the citizens?
- (iv) What is the reaction of the listeners to the reading of the 'Will'?

C) *'That's odd-the man hadn't been paid yet. What a strange fellow!'*

"The sun has come out,' Baren Mullick was heard shouting. 'Silence! Silence! — Naresh, hurry up and get these people out of the way!'

- (i) Who is the speaker in the first line?
- (ii) Find a word from the given extract which means the same as 'a person in the same position, involved in the same activity, or otherwise associated with another'.
- (iii) Why does he call him 'a strange fellow'?
- (iv) Why did Patol Babu leave before he was paid?

9. Answer any **Five** out of six of the following questions in 30-40 words. (2x5=10 marks)

- a) "Mrs. Packletide indulges in no more big game shooting." What put her off from going on further hunts?
- b) Why did the news of the 'miracle recovery' shock Michael?
- c) What genre of stories does Jenkins want the narrator to write? Why?
- d) "Tortured by doubt and remorse, he sat down in the glow of the charcoal sign to wait." Who is tortured by doubt and remorse? Why? What is he waiting for?
- e) Bring out the irony in the poem, 'Ozymandias'.
- f) Why did the poet wait for the snake to quench its thirst first?
- g) Why was the family surprised and horrified to see the grandfather awake?

10. Attempt any **one** of the following questions:

8m

The theme of superstition and omens is evident in both 'Julius Caesar' and the poem, 'The Rime of Ancient Mariner' Write a paragraph in about 150 words exploring the theme.

OR

Materialistic things don't really last. What matters most, are the people we care about and the values we live with .Explain the significance of this statement in reference to the poem "Not marble nor the gilded monuments".

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